

IN CONTEXT

The Aldeburgh Festival

Benjamin Britten lived for much of his life in Aldeburgh, a small town on the Suffolk coast in eastern England. In 1948, with friends, he staged a music festival in a local hall. Held annually, the festival grew in size and prestige. In 1965, Britten identified the Maltings, a 19th-century industrial building in the nearby village of Snape, as the potential site for a concert hall. Opened in 1967, the Snape Maltings became the focus of the annual music festival, which still attracts top performers from around the world.